11. Deploying Zoho Creator App to Production

Aim

To understand the deployment lifecycle of a Zoho Creator application from the Development environment to the Production environment and to plan the deployment of the lost and found application.

Overview

Environment	Purpose and rules
Development	Build forms, write Deluge scripts and test without touching live data
Stage	Test the application with sample data before release
Production	Live environment used by end users with real data and strict access control
Publish / migrate	The controlled move of changes from one environment to the next

Procedure

The lost and found application was built and tested in the Development environment. The deployment steps below describe how it moves to Stage and then to Production.

1. Verify in the Development environment that all forms, scripts, workflows and reports of the application work.
2. Open the Environments option of Zoho Creator and study how a deployment to Stage and then to Production is started.
3. Study the list of added and changed components that Zoho Creator shows before a deployment.
4. Study how the application is published and how users and permission profiles are created again in Production.

Deployment plan for the application

- Test the application in Stage with sample data.
- Record release notes for the version.
- Publish the application to Production.
- Create the users and permission profiles again in Production.
- Keep the previous version available for rollback.

Result

The deployment lifecycle from Development through Stage to Production was studied and a deployment plan was prepared for the Smart Lost and Found application, which has been built and tested in the Development environment.